

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 97 Handout — Rehearse the happy path and the failure path — interviews are pipelines too

10 - Portfolio & Public Launch · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — five questions as a career pipeline

Question	Happy path (say this)	Failure path (also say this)
Promote the same artifact across envs?	One CI build; Environments download that artifact/digest	If you rebuild in prod, go back to Day 39
Secret landed in a PR?	Rotate, treat the PR as an incident, rewrite history if needed	'Delete the line and merge' leaves the secret in Git
Pipeline red Friday 17:00?	Who is affected, revert vs fix-forward with a clock	YOLO to prod to paint the dashboard green
Branching for this repo?	Trunk + PRs + path filters (your ADR)	A branching novel you cannot draw
Rollback after a bad deploy?	Redeploy last Build.BuildId / swap slot	Hotfix on main with no last-good

Architecture B — how to answer 'I do not know'

Urge	Do	Do not
Blank on a tool	'I would open X and verify Y'	Invent a confident wrong
DORA metrics	Define the four; say you did not measure a team's numbers	Invent a lead-time percentage
Work story itching	Use the public demo-shipboard	Identify an employer or a client
Rambling	Stop; four bullets; say it again	A 8-minute tour of your whole career
Recording dread	Record once; listen once	Skip the recording and only type answers

Architecture C — interview failure modes you can rehearse

Pitfall	What you hear yourself say	Fix
Rebuild in prod	'We compile again to be safe'	Same artifact; say Build.BuildId
Secret shrug	'Just revert the file'	Rotate + history
Friday hero	'I would patch live'	Clock, blast radius, revert
Fake DORA	'Our MTTR is 4 minutes'	Define metrics; no invented team numbers
Typed only	Perfect markdown, frozen voice	Out loud is the lab

One-liner to remember

Interviews are pipelines for your career — rehearse the happy path and the failure path.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal time. Record on your own device. Use the public capstone as the example — no employer stories that identify a workplace.

- 1 Write the five questions in docs/mock-interview-day97.md with 4-bullet answers: artifact promotion, secret in a PR, Friday red pipeline, branching, rollback.
- 2 Add DORA: name the four metrics in one sentence each. Do not invent numbers you never measured.

- 3 Answer all five out loud. Record yourself once (phone voice memo is enough).
- 4 Listen once. If you ramble, tighten the bullets and say the weak answer again.
- 5 For any 'I do not know', write where you would look and what you would verify.
- 6 Do not include workplace-identifying stories. The capstone is the exhibit.

Prompt card — say it, then listen once

```
# Q1: How do you promote the same artifact across envs?
# Q2: A secret appeared in a PR — what do you do?
# Q3: Pipeline red on Friday 17:00 — what is the playbook?
# Q4: What branching strategy does this repo use and why?
# Q5: How do you roll back a bad deploy without a hero hotfix?
# DORA: deployment frequency, lead time, CFR, MTTR — define, do not invent.
```

Done checklist

- Five answers written as 4-bullet cards
- Recorded and listened once
- Happy path and failure path both spoken
- No invented DORA numbers, no employer-identifying story
- docs/mock-interview-day97.md on the personal repo

Tomorrow — Day 98

Professional profile setup — policy first, volume second